

Naresh Pentapati

Product Experience & Design Leader

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Executive Summary

Product and UX leader with 20+ years of experience across B2B, B2C and government platforms. Currently Head of Creative and Associate Vice President at Photon, heading the EMEA creative team and leading AI-first and agentic application experiences while staying hands-on with product development.

My work spans market and domain research, product definition, UX and interaction design, frontend development, and solution and experience consulting. I work across insurance, fintech, gaming, health tech and public services, connecting user needs with practical delivery.

Over the last 18 months, I have applied AI to design and product workflows, built AI and low-code proofs of concept, and taken EMIdaddy and invite-only realIQ through end-to-end implementation. My focus is on making complex products clear, useful and workable.

Key Competencies

- Product Vision & Strategy
- Customer-Centric Innovation
- AI-Driven Product Development
- Agile Product Lifecycle Management
- Go-to-Market Planning
- DesignOps & Scalable Delivery
- Cross-functional Leadership
- Data-Driven Decision Making
- UX Collaboration & Prototyping
- KPI & OKR Alignment
- Stakeholder Communication
- Market & Domain Research

Professional Experience

Photon Interactive | Head of Creative / Associate Vice President

May 2026 – Present

- Head the EMEA creative team, leading creative and UX work across the region.
- Lead AI-first and agentic application experiences for leading corporations worldwide.
- Manage delivery alongside team leadership, keeping design work and implementation moving together.
- Lead and train the UX team in applying AI to everyday UX work.
- Run regular sessions on the latest AI models, covering performance, pricing and practical capabilities to keep the team current.
- Build AI agents and proofs of concept to support design and product workflows and validate new ideas.

Areteans | Head of Product Experience

May 2021 – Apr 2026

- Led product vision and delivery for digital transformation initiatives across **Fortune 500 clients** in **insurance, finance, and government sectors**, leveraging **Pega** and **React SDK**.
- Defined and aligned product strategy, KPIs, and OKRs across multi-region accounts, resulting in a **30% uplift in feature adoption** and measurable ROI.
- Spearheaded **AI integration in product planning**, including journey prediction, content automation, and personalized UX, accelerating **MVP delivery by 30%**.
- Championed collaboration across **product, engineering, UX, and business units**, improving sprint efficiency and reducing design-developer handoff time by **25%**.
- Actively contributed to **pre-sales and RFP processes**, helping secure high-value deals through product vision walkthroughs and interactive prototypes.
- Mentored a team of 30+ design and product professionals across regions, scaling capability maturity through **DesignOps** and **Agile PM frameworks**.

Selected AI and Product Work

EMIdaddy | End-to-end product implementation

- Defined the product for borrowers managing loan costs and repayment choices, covering domain research, product priorities, UX, UI development and end-to-end implementation.
- Designed guided affordability flows, quick and detailed expense entry, and reusable calculator controls with direct inputs, sliders, presets and optional advanced settings.
- Built loan onboarding with document upload, editable review and manual-entry alternatives, alongside debt dashboards, amortization schedules and repayment comparisons.

realIQ | End-to-end implementation for invited users

- Owned the product definition, UX and end-to-end implementation of an invite-only real-estate intelligence platform, bringing project, village and land information into connected workflows.
- Shaped map-first exploration, progressive detail views and clear source limitations. Refined sign-in, reusable controls and error feedback to keep the interface consistent.

Hekla | AI app-builder proof of concept

- Owned product definition, UX and implementation of a validated POC connecting AI-generated React interfaces to Pega DX APIs.
- Designed a browser workflow for code generation, live preview, editing and GitHub publishing, with authentication and Vercel deployment.

Beetle | Visual low-code prototype

- Designed and prototyped a builder with reusable components, live preview and a stage/step/page structure. Mapped UI configuration to Pega JSON and defined Figma import and React/TypeScript export requirements.

Olfra | AI-assisted fragrance platform in development

- Shape product requirements and user workflows across ingredient intelligence, formulation and compliance, connecting the product plan with interface and development decisions.

Certifications

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| • International Certificate in Product Management (IPL-ICPM) | • Certified Scrum Professional - Product Owner (CSP-PO) |
| • Certified Usability Analyst (CUA) - Human Factors International | • Certified System Architect (CSA v7.2) |
| • Certified Scrum Master (CSM) | • Certificate in Generative AI Mastery (IIT, Hyderabad) |
| • Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) | • Blockchain Basics (LinkedIn) |
| • Certified Scrum Professional - Scrum Master (CSP-SM) | |

Tool Stack

Figma, FigJam, Adobe XD, Sketch, Miro, React SDK, Pega UI, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, Node.js, Git, Jira, Confluence

Strategic & Operational Skills

Leadership & Collaboration:

- Product Visioning & Roadmap Alignment
- Stakeholder Influence & Cross-functional Alignment
- Empathetic Leadership & Team Mentorship
- Executive Communication & Conflict Resolution
- Decision Making Under Uncertainty
- Adaptability & Continuous Learning

Product & Program Execution:

- Agile Product Lifecycle Management (Scrum, SAFe)
- Prioritization, Sprint Planning & Iteration Management
- Resource Allocation & Capacity Planning
- KPI/OKR Definition & Outcome Tracking
- Risk Assessment & Mitigation Strategies
- Budget & Timeline Ownership
- Scalable Process Design & Governance

Languages

English, Hindi, Telugu

Ivy | Senior Product Manager

Dec 2020 – May 2021

- Supported **Entain PLC**'s global betting platforms (Ladbrokes, Coral, Gala) by driving backend product strategy across player account, wallet, and responsible gaming services.
- Owned and prioritized the product roadmap for mission-critical systems, focusing on uptime, scalability, and cross-market compliance.
- Collaborated with engineering, architecture, and regulatory teams to align feature delivery with legal and operational standards in key regions.
- Delivered backend improvements that enhanced platform reliability and accelerated service delivery across Entain's betting ecosystem.

Larsen & Toubro | Head of Product Management and Design

Sep 2019 – Dec 2020

- Led the product vision and UX design for the **Integrated Safe City Platform**, a mission-critical system designed for law enforcement, traffic, and emergency response teams across multiple Indian cities.
- Owned roadmap and design strategy for high-impact modules such as **Command & Control, Patrol Management, Disaster Management, Investigation Tools, and Citizen Applications**—resulting in a 28% increase in post-launch citizen satisfaction.
- Collaborated with stakeholders from **law enforcement, traffic, disaster management, and women safety task forces** to align digital workflows with cross-agency operational goals.
- Introduced **design governance** and agile delivery practices that reduced design-dev handoff delays by 20%, while ensuring regulatory compliance and real-time GIS-based visualizations.
- Delivered a scalable, AI-augmented platform featuring **video analytics, incident response, women safety tools, and citizen-facing mobile apps**—contributing to city-wide safety initiatives and policy influence.

EY | Product Manager

Aug 2018 – Sep 2019

- Directed product strategy for **OnePortal (e-Pragati)**, a unified citizen services platform for the Government of Andhra Pradesh, consolidating **750+ services across 33 departments**.
- Defined and prioritized the product roadmap, aligning stakeholders across engineering, IT governance, and policy teams to deliver scalable and compliant solutions.
- Architected modular product capabilities for **service orchestration, role-based access, and multilingual personalization**, enabling high availability across web and mobile channels.
- Established success metrics around platform adoption, transaction throughput, and service response time—standardized into a governance dashboard for department-level visibility.
- Embedded UX principles into platform guidelines to enhance accessibility, improve service discoverability, and reduce completion times across citizen journeys.

Pegasystems | Product Owner

Oct 2016 – Sep 2018

- Owned the delivery and evolution of internal tools that improved front-end build efficiency by **30%**, enabling faster go-to-market for customer-facing apps.
- Defined backlog priorities and drove sprint planning in collaboration with engineering, resulting in improved velocity and reduced UI rework cycles.
- Partnered with design teams to scale **component-based UI systems** across the Pega platform, contributing to a consistent developer and user experience.
- Championed **accessibility enhancements** across key modules, leading to compliance with **WCAG 2.1** standards and improved inclusivity.
- Led UX debt analysis to balance quick wins with long-term product stability, aligning design priorities with technical feasibility and roadmap goals.

Deloitte Digital | Senior Consultant (UI & Scrum Master)

Apr 2013 – Oct 2016

- Led digital product transformation for clients such as **DuPont**, **ING Direct Australia**, and the **UK Government**, delivering scalable solutions across intranet, public portals, and citizen platforms.
- Drove UX strategy and agile delivery for **ING Direct's customer portal (DNA – Digital Next Generation Application)** in Sydney, enhancing omni-channel banking experiences.
- Spearheaded redesign of **DuPont's global intranet**, improving employee engagement and information discovery across departments and regions.
- Facilitated design sprints, MVP workshops, and backlog grooming sessions to align stakeholders on product goals, technical feasibility, and user needs.
- Balanced dual roles as **Scrum Master** and **UX SME**, increasing sprint throughput by 20% and fostering a culture of test-and-learn across cross-functional teams.

Host Analytics Inc (now Planful) | Senior Software Engineer

Aug 2012 – Apr 2013

- Developed **modular, reusable UI components** for enterprise financial planning tools, improving performance and reducing dev effort across multiple product lines.
- Collaborated closely with **product managers and UX leads** to align design intent with technical implementation in agile sprints.
- Contributed to accessibility enhancements and improved component scalability, laying groundwork for future roadmap features.
- Partnered with QA and engineering leadership to define standards for UI consistency, interaction patterns, and code maintainability.

MRops (now Dynata) | Associate Team Lead

Feb 2010 – Aug 2012

- Acted as **lead programmer and coordinator** for over **30 multi-market survey projects**, working across time zones and languages to support clients like **McDonald's**, **Pepsi**, **Toyota**, **Unilever**, **Ford**, and **Abbott**.
- Engineered reusable, multi-language front-end frameworks to support localization, scalability, and fast deployment across **20+ regions**.
- Delivered tailored survey solutions using diverse techniques including **brand positioning**, **concept testing**, **new product launches**, and **customer satisfaction** across **B2B and B2C segments**.
- Collaborated with global research and project teams to define survey logic, response validation, and analysis-ready data flows, ensuring accurate and actionable insights.

Kantar Operations | Software Engineer

Jan 2007 – Feb 2010

- Kickstarted my professional journey by building **global survey interfaces** supporting large-scale, multilingual data collection across multiple regions.
- Collaborated with international project teams to deliver **multi-market B2B and B2C surveys**, gaining early exposure to stakeholder communication and delivery coordination.
- Developed reusable UI templates and validated front-end logic for brand tracking, customer feedback, and new product evaluation studies.
- Improved performance by **30%** through front-end optimization in **JavaScript**, **HTML**, and **CSS**, resulting in higher form completion and lower drop-off rates.

Education

Birla Institute of Technology and Science (BITS), Pilani - MBA, Artificial Intelligence (Apr 2025 - Apr 2027, expected)
Institute of Product Leadership - International Certificate in Product Management (ICPM) (2017)
Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University - B.Tech, Information Technology (2002 - 2006)